

SPX Options Flow — Weekly Macro Briefing

Weekly Options Flow & Dealer Positioning Analysis

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▲ LONG GAMMA

RISK: MEDIUM

Composite Score: 0.22

SPX SPOT 6,606	NET GEX +0.52B	GAMMA FLIP 5,970	DIST. TO FLIP +9.6%	CALL WALL #1 6,225	PUT WALL #1 5,950
MAX PAIN 6,040	VIX 24.01				

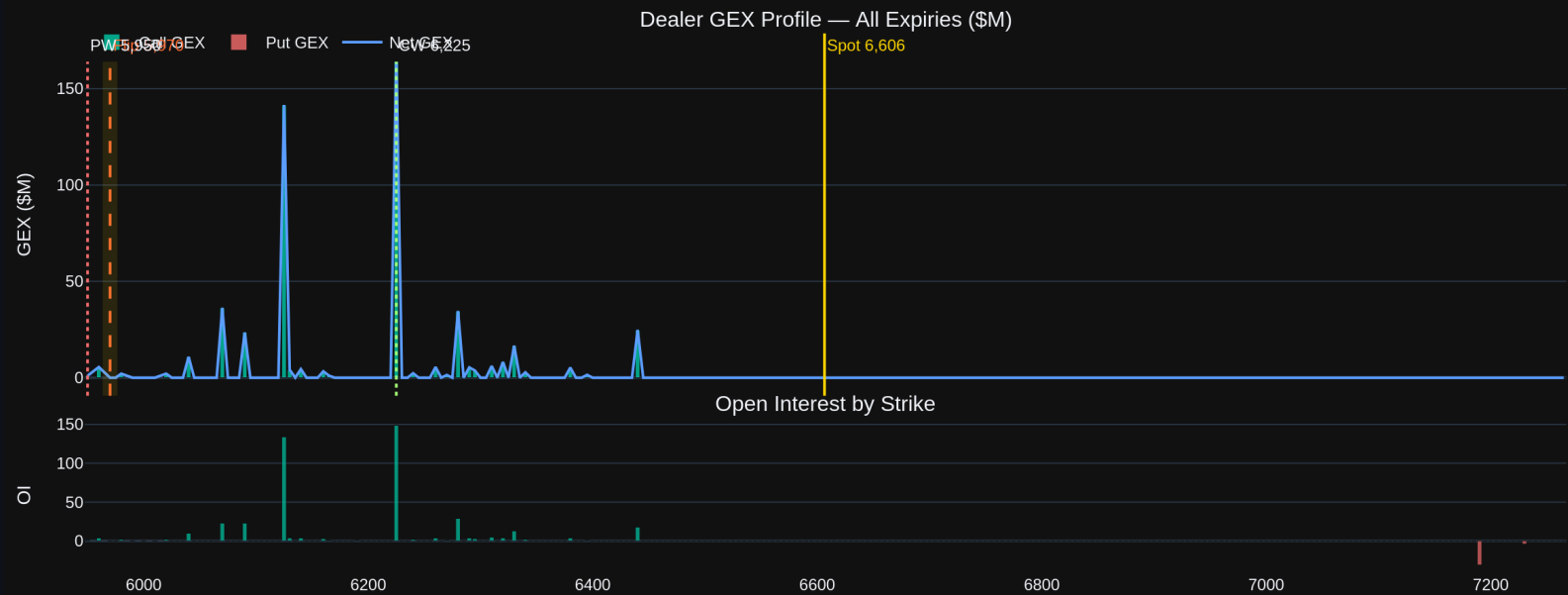
Dealers are in LONG GAMMA with net GEX of \$+0.52B. Spot (6,606) sits 9.6% above the gamma flip level (5,970). Composite macro score: +0.22 → Risk Level: MEDIUM. Key risks: none identified.

REGIME PLAYBOOK

▲ EQUITIES Range-trade, sell OTM straddles on strength	◆ VOLATILITY Short VIX / sell vol spikes — dealers will absorb moves	◆ OPTIONS STRATEGY Iron condors, credit spreads, short strangles	◆ POSITION SIZING Normal to increased — stable regime supports risk-on
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GEX Profile — Dealer Gamma Exposure

March 20, 2026



KEY LEVELS

STRIKE	TYPE	GEX	DIST. FROM SPOT	INTERPRETATION
6,225	Call Wall	+169M	-5.8%	Below-spot call concentration / dealer buyback support
6,125	Call Wall	+142M	-7.3%	Below-spot call concentration / dealer buyback support
6,070	Call Wall	+36M	-8.1%	Below-spot call concentration / dealer buyback support
5,950	Put Wall	+0M	-9.9%	Downside accelerator / dealer selling pressure below spot
5,960	Put Wall	+0M	-9.8%	Downside accelerator / dealer selling pressure below spot
5,970	Put Wall	+0M	-9.6%	Downside accelerator / dealer selling pressure below spot

OPEX: 2026-03-20 (0 DTE)

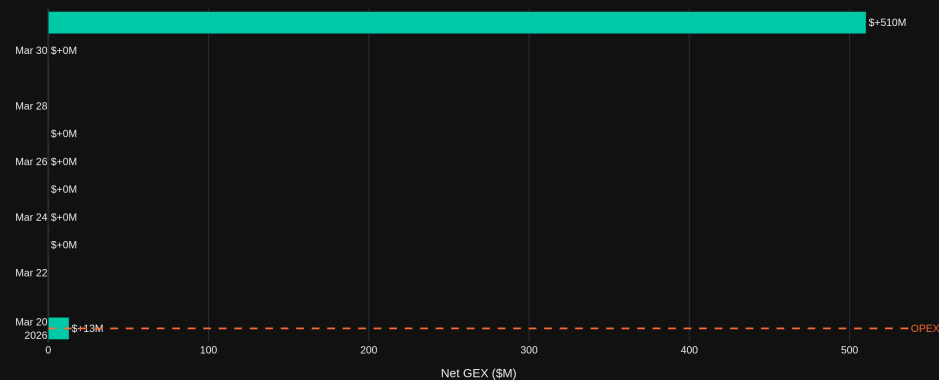
Net GEX Expiring	% of Total Book
\$+13M	2.5%

Expiry Roll-Off & Delta Exposure

March 20, 2026

GEX BY EXPIRY

Net GEX by Expiry — Roll-Off Profile (\$M)



DEX PROFILE

Dealer Delta Exposure (DEX) by Strike (\$M)



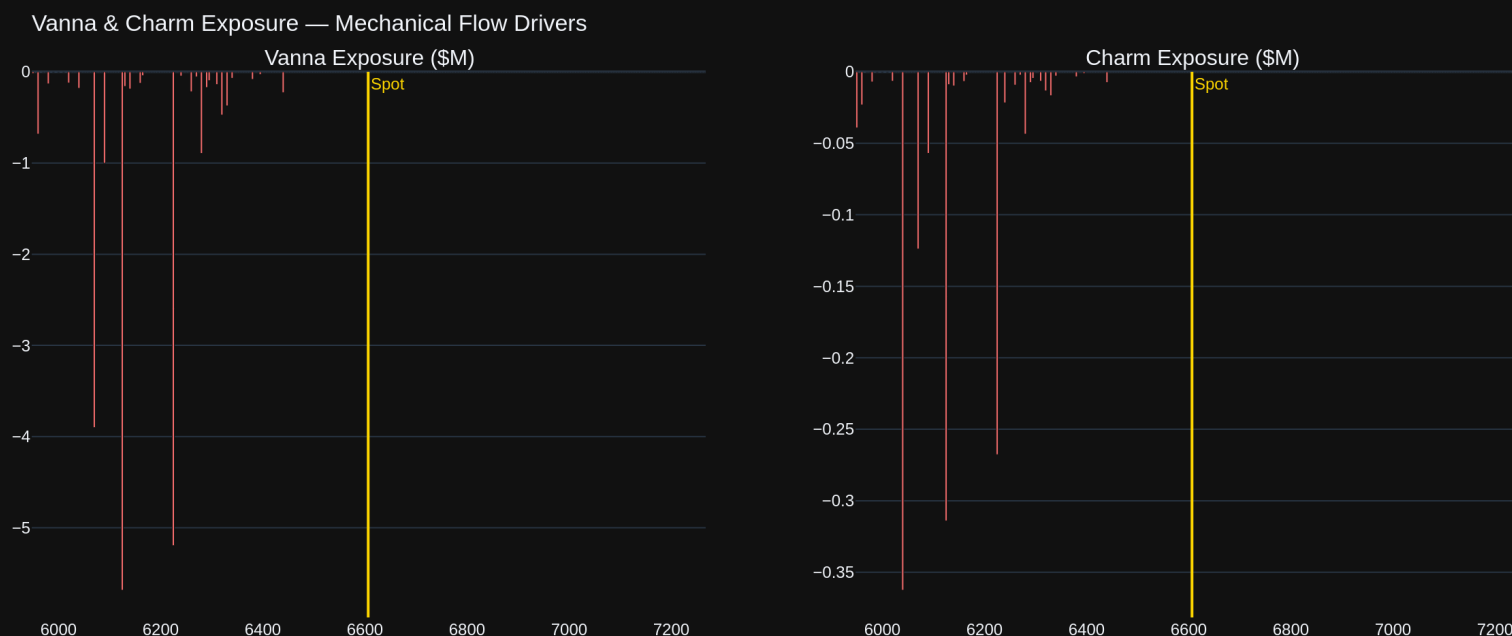
OPEX-SPECIFIC GEX (2026-03-20)

GEX Profile — 2026-03-20 (OPEX Only)



Max Pain: 6,040 — Market tends to gravitate toward max-pain strike in the final trading sessions before OPEX as dealers neutralise hedges.

VANNA & CHARM EXPOSURE

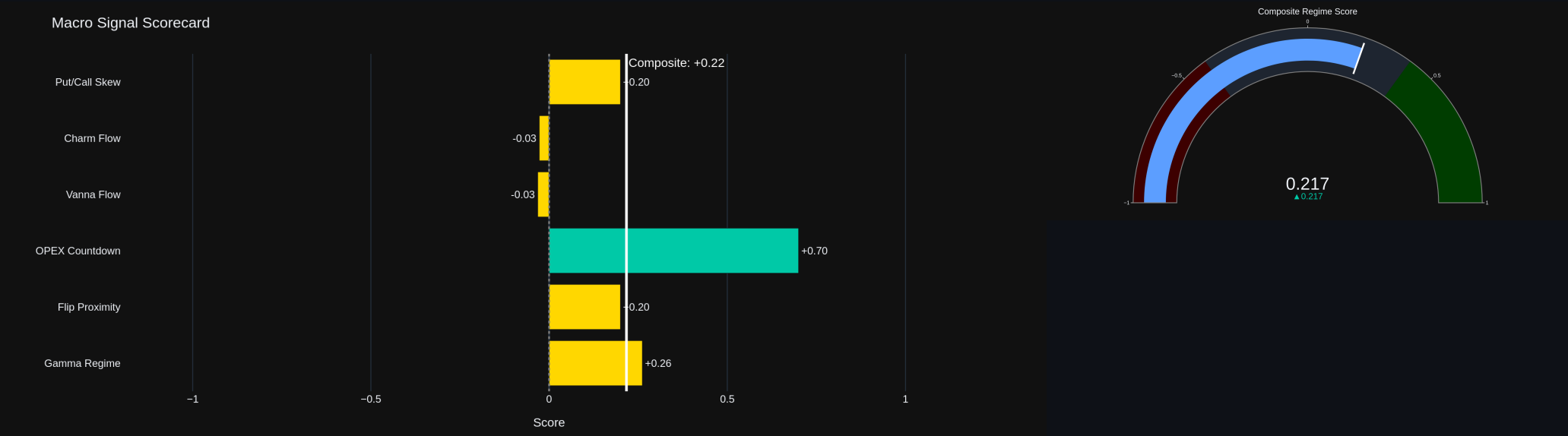


Vanna ($d\Delta/d\sigma$): when implied vol changes, dealers mechanically re-hedge their delta. Positive net vanna exposure = vol compression creates systematic equity buying pressure. Negative net vanna = vol expansion creates systematic equity selling pressure. **Charm ($d\Delta/dT$ per day):** delta decays daily with time even if price does not move. Near OPEX this effect accelerates sharply and can distort intraday price action.

PUT/CALL OI RATIO BY STRIKE



Put/Call OI Ratio (this chart): open-interest-based ratio per strike. Strikes with OI ratio > 1.5 have heavy put accumulation relative to calls — typically defensive institutional hedging. Strikes near zero or NaN had insufficient call OI (< 10 contracts) and are suppressed. **Note:** the Put/Call Skew signal on the Signal Dashboard uses a separate *GEX-weighted* ratio (total put GEX / total call GEX), not this OI chart. The two metrics are related but not identical — OI ratio reflects positioning volume, GEX ratio reflects gamma exposure and dealer hedging pressure.



SIGNAL DETAIL

Gamma Regime

BULLISH_VOL_SELL

+0.26

WEAK

Net GEX = \$+0.52B → dealers are LONG GAMMA. Spot is 9.6% above gamma flip at 5,970.

- Equities: expect mean-reversion, sell strength into resistance
- Vol: VIX likely to fade on spikes — sell vol spikes
- Options: credit spreads / iron condors favoured

Flip Proximity

ABOVE FLIP: STABLE

+0.20

WEAK

Spot (6,606) is 9.6% above gamma flip (5,970). Dealer support likely on dips toward flip.

- Watch 5,970 as key inflection — sustained close above = regime shift
- Volatility clustering risk increases near flip

OPEX Countdown

OPEX 0DTE

+0.70

STRONG

OPEX in 0 DTE (CRITICAL urgency). \$+13M net GEX expiring = 2.5% of total book. Pin behaviour likely near OPEX strikes.

- Pin risk: market may gravitate to max-pain strike $\pm 0.5\%$ as OPEX approaches
- Post-OPEX: expect vol reset once large GEX concentration expires
- Book impact: 2.5% of dealer delta hedging unwind at OPEX

Vanna Flow

VOL_RISE_OFFER_DAMPENED

-0.03

WEAK

Vanna exposure = \$-20M. Vol expansion → mechanical equity selling via delta re-hedging. VIX 1d change: -1.08 (falling) — diverging with vanna signal.

- Vol decline → dealer delta re-hedging creates systematic equity buying
- Watch VIX 1d direction as leading indicator of vanna flow direction
- Strong positive vanna + falling VIX = powerful mechanical tailwind

Charm Flow

DAILY_DELTA_OUTFLOW

-0.03

STRONG

Charm exposure = \$-1M/day. DTE=0: charm acceleration is sharp near expiry. Negative charm = net delta drain as time passes.

- Charm creates mechanical daily delta flows even with no price movement
- Near OPEX, charm accelerates and can distort intraday price action

Put/Call Skew

NEUTRAL_BALANCED

+0.20

WEAK

Put/Call GEX ratio = 0.00. Balanced put/call book — no strong directional skew. Put wall at 5,950 (-9.9% from spot).

- High put skew: dealers short puts → forced to sell into weakness, amplifying downside moves
- Hedging demand exceeds upside speculation — institutional risk-off signal

CROSS-ASSET GEX SUMMARY

INSTRUMENT	SPOT	NET GEX (\$B)	REGIME	FLIP LEVEL	DIST. TO FLIP	CALL WALL	PUT WALL
SPX — S&P 500 Index	6,606.49	+0.52B	LONG GAMMA	5,970.00	+9.6%	6,225	5,950
SPY — SPDR S&P 500 ETF	659.80	+0.00B	LONG GAMMA	595.00	+9.8%	595	595
QQQ — Invesco QQQ ETF	593.02	+0.00B	LONG GAMMA	570.00	+3.9%	571	535
IWM — iShares Russell 2000 ETF	247.63	+0.00B	LONG GAMMA	225.00	+9.1%	225	225

All instruments are in the same gamma regime — no cross-asset divergence detected. Monitor relative GEX levels and flip proximity for early signs of regime change.

